I'm 44 And I've Tracked Every Calorie For 20 Years

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 22, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/xAGf8P1lxiQ Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, 44, argues that everyone he knows who tracks calories is fit, and everyone who doesn't looks bad — dismissing influencer excuses and insisting calorie tracking is mandatory for long-term fitness.

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🔍 Observation: Calorie Trackers vs. Non-Trackers 0:00

- Carter's personal observation is blunt: **everyone he knows who measures their calories is in great shape**
  - Conversely, everyone who looks bad does not track calories
- He frames this as a clear, consistent pattern — not an exception

📱 The Instagram Influencer Myth 0:00

- He addresses the common social media trope of young women claiming to stay fit without counting calories
  - His rebuttal: those women are typically **19 years old** — a fundamentally different physiological situation from an adult man
  - He sarcastically notes their actual regimen: "They're just doing Adderall, Celsius, and vitamins. That's it."
    - Occasionally adding a matcha after Pilates
  - His point: copying a teenager's approach as an adult male is simply misguided logic
- He also calls out **male fitness influencers** who brag about not tracking calories
  - Quotes one influencer who said, "Calorie tracking isn't sustainable long-term"
  - Carter's response: he just laughed, saying the influencer "sounded like a total coward"

💪 20+ Years of Personal Tracking 0:43

- Carter states he has tracked his calories and macros for **more than 20 years**

    - This predates smartphones — before the iPhone, he and others used **physical notebooks**
        - They carried notebooks everywhere to manually calculate calories
        - He openly acknowledges: "It was hard. I admit that. It was genuinely difficult back then."
- He uses this history to strip away the modern excuse that tracking is too hard

⚖️ The Modern Ease of Tracking 0:43

- Today, tracking requires nothing more than **typing numbers into a phone app**
    - He rhetorically challenges the viewer: "Do you think typing numbers into your phone is too hard?"
- Carter carries a **food scale with him everywhere** — restaurants, events, other people's homes

> "If you want to be fit, you have to track your calories." — his closing, non-negotiable conclusion

- The overarching message: the barrier to tracking has never been lower; the only remaining obstacle is willingness